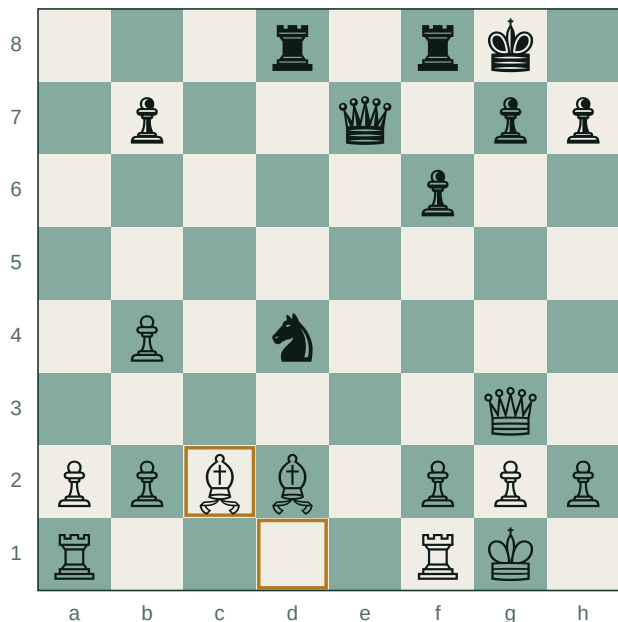


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 20

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Bxc2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Ne2+ 21. Kh1 Nxg3+ 22. fxg3 Rxd2

20...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From e2 it attacks king on g1 and queen on g3. Recorded reply: **21.Kh1**.

21...Nxg3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From g3 it attacks king on h1 and rook on f1. Recorded reply: **22.fxg3**.

22...Rxd2 The rook captures the bishop on d2.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -5 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: bishop on d2 and bishop on c2. Check for tactical protection.